

Department of Public Safety

Board of Chiefs

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Memorandum For: Department of Public Safety Personnel

Subject: DPS Advanced Department Handbook

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Our Department:

The Department of Public Safety was established to ensure public safety and provide the necessary services to help restore civility within the State of Liberty. Our department motto is as follows: "**Justice, Integrity, Freedom.**" We strive to be a valuable resource to our citizens.

We enforce these values to an absolute and non-negotiable standard. Our success is measured only by our adherence to this duty; **those who cannot uphold this standard will not serve here.**

1. Our Regulations

- **Representation:** You are expected to maintain a professional and courteous appearance at all times.
 - You are expected to abide by our department's policies at all times.
 - You are expected to utilize proper spelling, punctuation, and grammar.
 - You are expected to remain respectful and subordinate to your higher-ranking personnel
- **Communication:** You are expected to maintain clear and effective communication with everyone.
 - You are expected not to disrupt communications within our radio channels by:
 - Providing invalid information.
 - Speaking over another officer who is transmitting.
 - Conversing and/or chatting unnecessarily.
 - You may have an account inside Global RTO (1) and function to maintain hearing capabilities whenever on patrol.
 - You should be able to hear and understand radio traffic when out on patrol.
- **Appearance:** You must present yourself as a professional and orderly individual at all times.
 - You are permitted to have hair coloring of black, brown, gray, orange, and white.
 - You are permitted to wear a police, sheriff, or trooper vest with visible markings on the front and back.
 - You are permitted to wear a police, sheriff, or trooper hat/cap with or without markings.
 - You are permitted to wear a shoulder microphone.
 - You are permitted to wear a waist, leg, or half-leg holster in the color black.
 - You are required to wear a black duty belt.
 - This may be either a custom-purchased belt or the in-game provided duty belt.
 - You are permitted to have visible tattoos on your arms and legs; however, tattoos may not be visible on your head or torso.
 - Tattoos that are offensive are not permitted
 - You are not permitted to have visible jewelry on your person.
 - You are not permitted to have any character package other than the 1.0 package.
 - You are not permitted to have additional accessories without approval from a captain or above.
- **Engagement:** You must engage with citizens in a professional and courteous manner at all times.
 - You are required to provide a supervisor or higher-ranking officer if available upon request.
 - Supervisors are not required to provide an additional, higher-ranking supervisor.
 - If a supervisor is on scene and a suspect or individual requests a supervisor, the Supervisor on scene must request a supervisor of Equal or Higher Authority without knowledge of the scene to respond and gather and render unbiased decisions.
 - You are not permitted to directly or indirectly threaten anyone.
 - You are not permitted to directly or indirectly disrespect anyone.
- **Logging:** You must log all shift, citations, arrests, warnings, and BOLOs in the TBD
 - Log Format:

- Example: N/A



2. Restrictions

When representing the department, you must follow the following restrictions regarding the use of department-issued tools, vehicles, and equipment.

These restrictions must be followed at all times. Unless otherwise stated, the use of restricted items is not permitted.

Vehicles Section

Vehicle Accessory	Type	Accessible by	Notes
ALPR	Optional	All	Automatic License Plate Recognition.
Push Bar	Optional	All	Push Bar. If you do have one you cannot partake into a pursuit.
Antennas	Optional	All	Antennas
Cage	Mandatory	All	Cage to transport suspects. (Required by LT's and below.)
Laptop	Mandatory	All	Laptop to run the CAD system.
Dash Light	Mandatory	Supervisors	Type of Light Bar. Mandatory for 3D's below.
Edge Light Bar	Mandatory	All	Type of Light Bar. Mandatory for 3D's below.
Integrity Light Bar	Mandatory	All	Type of Light Bar. Mandatory for 3D's below.
Legacy Light Bar	Mandatory	All	Type of Light Bar. Mandatory for 3D's below.
Valor Light Bar	Mandatory	All	Type of Light Bar. Mandatory for 3D's below.
Visor Lights	Optional	Supervisors	Type of Light Bar. Optional for Supervisors
Rear Light Bar	Optional	Supervisors	Type of Light Bar. Optional for Supervisors
Small rear lightstick	BANNED	N/A	A banned Vehicle Accessory
Small Spoiler Lights	Optional	Lieutenants +	Type of rear light option. Optional for Lieutenants
All Other Rear lighting Options	Optional	All	N/A
Ghosted Livery	Optional	Supervisors	Type of Livery to apply on a patrol vehicle



Tools Section

Tool	Type	Accessible by	Notes
Shield 9, Glock 17, M&P 9, or Sauer P226	Lethal firearm	All personnel ▾	Required.
M4A1	Lethal firearm	All personnel ▾	Heavy firearm use only.
Taser	Less-lethal tool	All personnel ▾	Required.
Pepper spray	Less-lethal tool	All personnel ▾	Required.
Baton	Less-lethal tool	All personnel ▾	Required.
Duty Belt	General Tool	All personnel ▾	Required.
Beanbag shotgun	Less-lethal tool	All personnel ▾	General patrol use.
All additional tools except	General.	All personnel ▾	General patrol use.
Surveillance drone	Specialized tool	Division ▾	General divisional use.
Safety rope	Specialized tool	Division ▾	General divisional use.
SWAT Gear	Specialized tool	Division ▾	General divisional use.

3. Our Policies

We have various policies within the department that outline expectations, procedures, and operational standards. These policies must be followed at all times. Sections will be divided by bulletin.

- Pursuit Policy: A [Pursuit Policy](#) has been created separately to outline all regulations and procedures regarding vehicle pursuits.
- Use of Force: Officers may encounter individuals who present hostile behavior toward themselves or others. A [Use of Force Policy](#) has been created separately to outline the limitations, requirements, and appropriate levels of force when responding to such situations.
- Department Resources: The department provides officers with various tools, vehicles, and equipment. Policies are established to ensure their proper and responsible use.
 - Vehicles: Department vehicles are available for the River City Police Department, Liberty State Highway Patrol, and Liberty County Sheriff's Office. Officers assigned a department vehicle must:
 - Not use emergency lighting for personal gain.
 - Exercise caution when operating department vehicles.
 - Obey all traffic laws and regulations.
 - Tools: Tools referenced in Section 2 must be used appropriately.
 - Equipment may only be used within its intended and authorized scenarios.
 - Equipment may not be used for personal gain.



- Pepper Spray & Baton (L1): Short-range compliance and cooperation tools.
- Taser & Beanbag Shotgun (L2): Medium-range apprehension tools that are authorized after L1 options have been considered or utilized.
- Uniform: Department attire may only be worn while actively representing the department.
- Civil Rights: Officers must be knowledgeable of constitutional rights and applicable laws.
 - First Amendment: Guarantees freedoms concerning religion, speech, press, assembly, and the right to petition the government.
 - Second Amendment: Protects an individual's right to keep and bear arms for lawful purposes, including self-defense.
 - Fourth Amendment: Protects individuals from unreasonable searches and seizures by the government. Warrants are generally required unless an established legal exception applies.
 - Ninth Amendment: States that the enumeration of certain rights in the Constitution shall not be construed to deny or disparage other rights retained by the people.
 - Fourteenth Amendment: Grants citizenship to persons born or naturalized in the United States and guarantees equal protection under the law.
- Callsigns: Authorized callsigns for officers while on duty.
 - Unranked Officers: Authorized to use callsigns in the format 4D-XX.
 - Department Personnel: All personnel holding the rank of Officer through Corporal are authorized to use callsigns in the format 3D-XX.
 - Supervisory Personnel: Supervisors are assigned designated callsigns, which may vary by unit or bureau.
 - "XX" refers to any available two-digit number between 01 and 99 that is not already assigned.
- Miranda Warning: Officers must advise individuals of their Miranda Rights when required by law during custodial detention or arrest.
 - "You have the right to remain silent. Anything you say can and will be used against you in a court of law. You have the right to an attorney and to have an attorney present during questioning. If you cannot afford an attorney, one will be provided to you."

4. Disciplinary Policies

Categories of Misconduct:

- Minor Misconduct:
 - Repeated tardiness or attendance-related issues.
 - Minor violations of uniform, appearance, or grooming standards.
 - Failure to submit reports, paperwork, or required documentation within established deadlines.
 - Minor acts of insubordination or failure to follow lawful instructions.
 - Negligent performance of routine administrative responsibilities that do not result in significant operational impact.
- Major Misconduct:
 - Use of excessive or unlawful force.
 - Dishonesty, false reporting, or falsification of official records.
 - Discrimination, harassment, or retaliation against any individual.
 - Abuse or misuse of official authority or position.
 - Criminal conduct, whether on or off duty, reflects adversely on the department.
 - Reporting for duty under the influence of alcohol or illegal substances, or using prohibited substances while on duty.



- Unauthorized access to, misuse of, or disclosure of confidential information, department records, or law enforcement databases.
- Conduct unbecoming of a law enforcement officer that damages the integrity or reputation of the department.
- Failure to report known misconduct, policy violations, or criminal activity by department personnel.

• **Primary Disciplinary Actions**

- The following is a list of approved primary disciplinary actions that can be issued for violating certain policies within this handbook.

Disciplines:	Authorization:	Expiration:	Margin	Appealable	Description:
Verbal Warning	Office of Professional Standards	N/A	N/A	No	Does not impact an officer's record, is issued via direct message only, and is not formally logged.
Warning	Office of Professional Standards	30 Days	3	Yes	It is recorded in personnel updates, remains visible for 30 days, and then expires automatically.
2-Days Suspension	Office of Professional Standards	90 Days	3	Yes	Disallows the officer from representing DPS during the specified period.
14-Day Suspension (Admin. Leave)	Office of Professional Standards	120 Days	3	Yes	Disallows the officer from representing DPS during the specified period.
Demotion	Office of Professional Standards	N/A	N/A	Yes	Demotes the officer by one rank from their current position.
Termination	Office of Professional Standards	TBD	N/A	Yes	Removes the officer from DPS and revokes all medals and certifications.

- **Internal Investigations:** All members of the Department of Public Safety are obligated to cooperate in any investigation conducted by the Office of Professional Standards or the Board of Chiefs, and are obligated to comply with any reasonable and lawful requests. Failure to comply with internal investigations may result in disciplinary actions.
- The Office of Professional Standards and Board of Chiefs are not obligated to share evidence attached to a discipline you may have received. The Board of Chiefs reserves the right to discipline anyone for any lawful reason and is required to share a reason with you, along with the Office of Professional Standards.
- Any report filed with the Office of Professional Standards must be submitted within one month (30 days) from when the reported incident occurred. Any report that is found to have reached the statute of limitations shall not lead to disciplinary actions against the reported officer.



- **Additional Disciplinary Actions**

- The following disciplinary actions are authorized and may be imposed, when appropriate, for violations of this handbook. These disciplinary actions may be issued independently or in combination with a Primary Discipline, depending on the severity of the violation, the employee's disciplinary history, and any aggravating or mitigating circumstances.

Disciplines:	Authorization:	Duration:	Description:
Zero Tolerance Policy:	TBD	Any Fitting Duration	This can be given in addition to another discipline, and may be issued with an appropriate time duration.
Kick-off Team:	Supervisors	30m, 1h, 3h, 1d, 3d, and 7d.	This can be issued to an auxiliary officer and rejects them from any LEO team for the selected duration.
<u>Field Discipline:</u> <u>Unarmed Patrol</u>	Supervisors	1h, 3h, 12h, 24h, 48h, 72h, 7d.	Unarmed Patrol may be issued for violations of the Use of Force policy and prohibits officers from carrying a firearm while on patrol for the specified duration.

Administative

Handbook Authority:

- The Department of Justice (DOJ) Department of Public Safety (DPS) Handbook is the official source of departmental policies, rules, regulations, and procedures. It is issued and approved by the Chief of Department and applies to all DPS personnel.
- This handbook takes precedence over all other DPS-related policies, guides, and documentation unless explicitly stated otherwise.
- Any DPS handbook, guidebook, or other documentation containing policies, rules, regulations, or procedures must not contradict this handbook and must be reviewed, approved, and signed by Department Management before publication.
- Limited exemptions and accommodations to this handbook may be granted by Department Management; however, no exemption shall permit the violation of the United States Constitution or any applicable federal, state, or local laws, and all exemptions and accommodations must be documented in writing.

5. Acknowledgements

- This document is subject to change at any time. As a member of the Department of Public Safety, you are required to comply with all regulations, policies, and procedures outlined within this document, as well as any official directives, announcements, or guidance issued by the department administration.
- By joining the department as a cadet or sworn member or auxiliary member, you acknowledge and agree to abide by all department regulations and policies, whether contained within this document or communicated through official department channels.